



University of
Strathclyde
Glasgow



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Policy and Procedure on extensions to coursework submission

Version No.	Description	Author	Approval	Effective Date
1.0	Policy and Procedure on Extensions to Coursework Submission – applicable to both undergraduate and postgraduate taught programmes	Assessment and Feedback Working Group	Senate	From academic year 2019-20
1.1	Policy and procedure on extensions to coursework submission	Assessment and Feedback Working Group	Senate	From academic year 2024-25

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Policy and Procedure on extensions to coursework submission

Rationale

1. This policy aims to provide an institutional-wide approach to the consideration of requests for extensions to coursework submission deadlines. The policy is underpinned by a commitment to the fundamental objective of supporting students in their studies and recognition of the respective responsibilities of students and staff. The policy is designed to support students in planning their work sensibly. This policy must be implemented in line with the following other related policies: [Personal Circumstances and Academic Appeals Procedure](#), [Assessment and Feedback Policy](#), [Policy on Late Submission of Coursework](#), the [Disability Policy](#), and [Programme Regulations](#).

Scope

2. This policy applies to all taught elements of undergraduate and postgraduate programmes offered by the University. This policy applies to requests for extensions to coursework submission dates.
3. Where a student is absent from the university for more than seven calendar days, the Personal Circumstances and Academic Appeals Procedure should be referred to.
4. Students who are absent from any formal examination, should contact their academic department and refer to the Personal Circumstances and Academic Appeals Procedure.

Principles and guidelines for implementation

Grounds for granting an extension - Indicative circumstances

5. The following list of circumstances could constitute grounds for granting an extension. The list should be considered indicative and is not exhaustive.
 - a. Unforeseen circumstances such as a short-term illness, unanticipated caring commitments, family break up, being a victim of crime, being in an accident, jury service, significant relationship breakdown, homelessness, Home Office requirements, fire, flood, adverse weather conditions, exceptional travel circumstances beyond a student's control which prevented them from meeting the published submission date.
 - b. Other circumstances which are serious and negatively impact a student's preparation for an assessment such as medical conditions or illness, including physical and/or mental health problems, serious illness or death of a person close to the student.

- c. Other exceptional circumstances that can be reasonably considered to negatively impact a student's ability to meet the published submission date.

Grounds that are not acceptable for granting an extension - Indicative circumstances

- 6. The following list of circumstances would not be acceptable grounds for granting an extension. The list should be considered indicative and is not exhaustive:
 - a. poor planning and time management;
 - b. error made in understanding the published dates of assessment submissions;
 - c. having another assessment due on or around the same date;
 - d. minor IT issues such as computer failure;
 - e. failure of third parties to deliver the assessment;
 - f. holidays, social events, moving house, or any event planned in advance of the submission deadline; and
 - g. failure to make alternative travel plans when disruptions were advised in advance.

Coursework extension of up to and including seven calendar days

- 7. Extension requests will normally be made in advance of a coursework submission deadline.
- 8. Students must use the extension request facility on Myplace.
- 9. There is no requirement for students to submit formal evidence (e.g. a doctor's letter), however, students may be contacted by a member of staff prior to a decision being made about an extension request.
- 10. Extension requests will be assessed based on the reasons provided by the student and the number of previous extension requests made by the student.
- 11. Students are encouraged to communicate to staff any circumstances that are negatively impacting their studies as early as possible and seek support from appropriate University services. Where there are other aspects of their studies are also impacted, students should also refer to the Personal Circumstances and Academic Appeals Procedure.
- 12. In exceptional cases, students may apply for an extension retrospectively.

Coursework extension of more than seven calendar days

- 13. Students are encouraged to communicate to staff any circumstances that are negatively impacting their studies as early as possible and seek support from appropriate University services.
- 14. Extension requests will normally be made in advance of a coursework submission deadline.
- 15. Students must use the extension request facility on Myplace.
- 16. Students must also use the self-certificate facility on Pegasus to record the reasons that will affect their ability to meet the submission deadline and provide any relevant supporting evidence for the medical or personal circumstances that support this claim. This supporting evidence must be submitted in line with the Personal Circumstances and Appeals policy.

17. If evidence is not available at the time of making the extension request, it must be submitted within five working days of the agreed extension date.
18. Failure to submit relevant evidence of medical or personal circumstances could result in the extension approval being revoked and the application of the Policy on Late Submission of Coursework.
19. Where there are sensitivities or difficulties in obtaining evidence (for example, a death certificate), a compassionate approach will be taken.
20. In exceptional cases, students may apply for an extension retrospectively.

Consideration of extension requests

21. Extensions will not be granted beyond the date at which students receive feedback on the coursework for which the extended deadline is requested. This is usually 15 working days in line with the Assessment and Feedback Policy.
22. On receipt of an extension request, nominated staff should:
 - a. Check PEGASUS to see if the student has a Reasonable Adjustment report on the Disabled Students Requirements system. If there is a report, there may be further information relating to the impact on studies relevant to the extension request. This may be an explicit request to 'Give sympathetic consideration to requests for an extension of time for submitting assignments'. Adjustment reports are not uploaded to PEGASUS without the university holding robust medical evidence, and information in the reasonable adjustment report must be considered.
 - b. Check the student's extension request record in Myplace with a view to assessing the student's previous use of extensions and identify any additional support requirements.
23. Nominated staff will consider the grounds of the extension request, and will communicate one of three outcomes back to the student via Myplace:
 - a. The outcome may be to decline the request based on insufficient grounds.
 - b. The outcome may be to agree to the request based on sufficient grounds.
 - c. Nominated staff may also suggest a meeting is required to discuss the request and consider appropriate student support.
24. In deciding on the length of an extension, staff will consider the details of the extension request and the time lost by the student in preparing for an assessment.

Responsibilities for implementation

25. Departmental Staff are responsible for:
 - a. Ensuring this policy is applied consistently within and across programme(s).
 - b. Monitoring students' use of the extension request system using the User Extension Report and Programme Extension Report functions in Myplace, with a view to identifying and communicating with students who may require support.

- c. Providing the programme Personal Circumstances Board with the relevant Myplace extension requests records.
- d. Making students aware of the range of support services available within the University.
- e. Ensuring that the work of students is marked, and feedback returned within 15 working days (normally this equates to 21 calendar days, except where the period includes University closure days) of the submission deadline or the extended deadline for each student who has been granted an extension.
- f. Taking a consistent approach to responding to extension requests in a timely manner.
- g. Communicating with relevant staff, such as Programme Leaders/Directors or Year Tutors/Co-ordinators, any concerns they may have regarding student wellbeing following communication with a student in relation to an extension request.

26. Students are responsible for:

- a. Understanding the requirements of individual assessments, and actively engaging with assessment tasks by devoting appropriate time and effort.
- b. Finding out where, how, and when work is submitted.
- c. Communicating to relevant staff any circumstances that are negatively impacting their studies as early as possible.
- d. Understanding this policy and providing sufficient detail regarding the circumstances.
- e. Understanding and following related policies and procedures such as the Personal Circumstances and Academic Appeals Procedure, and the Policy on the Late Submission of Coursework.
- f. Seeking academic and/or pastoral support when needed.



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Appendix 1: Student support services

	Disability and Wellbeing Service (including Student Counselling Service and Student Health)	Student Financial Support	Learner Development Service	Strathclyde Students' Union's The Advice Hub	International Student Support
Webpage	https://www.strath.ac.uk/professionalservices/disabilityandwellbeing/contact/	https://www.strath.ac.uk/studentfinancialsupport/ https://www.strath.ac.uk/professionalservices/finance/student/	https://www.strath.ac.uk/studywithus/strathlife/academicsupport/	https://www.strathunion.com/support/	https://www.strath.ac.uk/studywithus/internationalstudents/whileyourehere/internationalstudentsupportteam/
Phone	0141 548 3402	/	0141 548 4064/4062	/	0141 548 4273
Email	disability-wellbeing@strath.ac.uk	financial-support@strath.ac.uk or finance-helpdesk@strath.ac.uk	learner-development@strath.ac.uk	strathunion.advice@strath.ac.uk	infoandadvice@strath.ac.uk
Campus address	Rm 467, Mary Dunn Wing, Learning & Teaching Building, 51 Richmond Street, Glasgow, G1 1XQ	Learning & Teaching Building, 55 Richmond Street, Glasgow, G1 1XQ	Learning & Teaching Building, 55 Richmond Street, Glasgow, G1 1XQ	Ground Floor Dame Jocelyn Bell Burnell Wing, Learning & Teaching Building 51 Richmond Street, Glasgow, G1 1XU	Level 4, Learning & Teaching Building, 55 Richmond Street, Glasgow, G1 1XQ

Appendix 2: Student Business email addresses

Student Business Business	studentbusiness-business@strath.ac.uk
Student Business Hass	studentbusiness-hass@strath.ac.uk
Student Business Postgraduate	studentbusiness-pg@strath.ac.uk

Student Business Engineering	studentbusiness-engineering@strath.ac.uk
Student Business Science	studentbusiness-science@strath.ac.uk